Davood Wadi

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Research and Teaching Areas: AI in Marketing and Business; Business Analytics; Marketing Analytics; Consumer Behavior; Large Language Models as Market Agents; Digital Transformation

I am a current **permanent resident** of Canada.

Academic Appointments

Researcher, McGill University **2026 – Present**
McGill Centre for the Convergence of Health and Economics

- Conducting research on generative AI and LLMs as surrogate consumers in collaboration with Prof. Yu Ma (Director, MCCHE), targeting leading marketing journals (*JAMS*, *JAR*).
- Collaborator on Prof. Yu Ma's SSHRC Insight Grant.
- Leading grant writing for the IVADO Exploratory Projects Program ($100,000).

Limited-term Assistant Professor, University Canada West **2024 – 2026**

- **Teaching.** Taught MBA courses in Application of AI in Business (BUSI 654), Digital Transformation (CMPT 641), and Cloud Computing Technologies (BUSI 653).
- **Curriculum Development.** Designed and developed AI and Business courses and academic programs to align with the British Columbia Degree Quality Assessment Board (DQAB) specifications and quality standards.

Lecturer, HEC Montréal **2023**

- Developed and delivered master's and PhD-level course titled *Machine Learning I: Large-Scale Data Analysis and Decision Making*.

Instructor, Great Learning **2021 – 2024**

- Delivered live online instruction and mentored industry professionals across executive education programs in partnership with *MIT Professional Education, UT Austin, and Johns Hopkins University*, serving diverse and international learner cohorts.
- Taught courses on Applied Generative AI, Agentic AI, NLP, and Generative AI for Business with Microsoft Azure OpenAI.
- Taught modules for the MIT Applied AI and Data Science Program, AI & Business Analytics, Deep Learning for Computer Vision, and Advanced Python.

Education

Ph.D. in Business Administration (Marketing), University of Montréal (HEC Montréal) **2019 – 2023**

- Best 2023 Ph.D. Thesis Award Finalist
- Dissertation: The Interplay of Altruism and Financial Incentives: Maximizing Online Reviews through Effective Messaging
- Co-Supervisors: *Prof. Sylvain Senecal, Prof. Marc Fredette*
- Completed Ph.D. coursework satisfying the core requirements of HEC Montréal's Ph.D. in Data Science (Machine Learning I, Deep Learning, Advanced Statistical Learning)

B.Sc. in Engineering, Sharif University of Technology **2011 – 2016**

Publications

Published: 1 A*, 2 B | **Under Review:** 1 A* | **In Preparation:** 1 A*, 2 A

Ranking Legend. ***CiteScore****: Scopus CiteScore.* ***IF****: Clarivate Impact Factor.* ***ABDC****: Australian Business Deans Council (A*=Elite, A=Excellent, B=Good).* ***CORE****: the premier ranking for Computer Science venues (A*=Top 4%).*

- **Wadi, D.**, Fredette, M., Senecal, S., & Legoux, R. (2026). *Be careful what you pay for: The effect of performance contingent incentives on online product reviews*. *Journal of Research in Interactive Marketing*, 1–25. [**IF: 11.6**; **CiteScore: 20.5**; Rank: 8/221 Marketing – 96th percentile; Acceptance Rate: 14.4%]
- **Wadi, D.**, Senecal, S., Fredette, M., & Legoux, R. (2026). *The interplay of altruism and financial incentives: Maximizing online reviews through effective messaging*. Journal of Electronic Commerce Research (Vol 27, Issue 2). [**IF: 4.1**; **CiteScore: 6.3**; Rank: 20/289 General Economics, Econometrics and Finance – 93rd percentile]
- **Wadi, D.**, & Fredette, M. (2025). *A Monte-Carlo Sampling Framework for Reliable Evaluation of Large Language Models Using Behavioral Analysis*. Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP 2025. **[CORE: A*; h5-index=218]**

Working Papers

- **Wadi, D.**, Ma, Y. (2026). *Shopping by Algorithm: How Agentic AI Deploys Human Heuristics as a Surrogate Consumer*.
  Status: **Major revision** at the *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science* Special Issue: Agents, Interfaces, and Ecosystems. **[ABDC: A*; h-index=234]**
- **Wadi, D.**, Ma, Y. (2026). *Whom Do AI Agents Work For? Role Assignment Induces Sponsorship Bias in LLM Recommenders*.
  Status: **Under review** for *Journal of Business Research*. **[ABDC: A]**
- **Wadi, D.**, Ma, Y. (2026). *Does Rank Still Matter? Position Bias When AI Agents Shop on Our Behalf*.
  Status: **Under review** for *Marketing Letters*. **[ABDC: A; h-index=125; IF: 2.7]**
- **Wadi, D.**, Ghodrat, M., Philp, M. (2026). *Every Token Counts: Isolating Latent Behavior of LLMs via Exact Likert Distributions*.
  Status: **In Preparation** for *ACL 2027*. **[CORE: A*; h5-index=236]**

Conference Presentations

- **Wadi, D.**, & Fredette, M. (2025). *A Monte-Carlo Sampling Framework for Reliable Evaluation of Large Language Models Using Behavioral Analysis*. Presented at **EMNLP 2025**, Suzhou, China, November 2025.

Industry Experience

AI Research Scientist, General Motors (GM) **2026 – Present**

- Collaborate with GM's R&D division on the application of generative AI in enterprise organizational settings.
- Leading development and writing of internal grants and patents.
- Active industry research partnership positioned for NSERC Alliance co-funded research on generative AI in organizational contexts.

Scientist-in-Residence, Vope Medical **2022**

- Led applied AI research and development in collaboration with an industry partner, translating academic methods into product development and performance optimization.

Marketing Director, BaharAram.com **2016 – 2019**

- Led digital marketing, CRM, SEO/SEM, email, and social media strategy for an e-commerce business, contributing to a 166% increase in sales.

Marketing Analyst, BaharAram.com **2011 – 2016**

Research Funding and Awards

Collaborator, SSHRC Insight Grant (PI: Prof. Yu Ma) **2026 – Present**
Contributing to federally funded research on generative AI and LLMs as surrogate consumers, McGill University.

Google Gemini Academic Program Award ($10,000) **2025**
Covering ongoing research expenses for my work on AI agents as surrogate consumers, supporting the pipeline behind my paper under review at *JAMS* and my *Findings of EMNLP* 2026 publications.

UCW Explore Grant in Teaching Innovation **2025**
Awarded funding to develop "AILSS: AI-Powered Learning Support System," which uses Large Language Models for formative assessment and personalized support for students with disabilities.

IVADO Scientist-in-Residence Scholarship ($10,000) **2022**
Funding secured to support applied AI research at Vope Medical, contributing to core product development.

IVADO PhD Excellence Scholarship ($100,000) **2020**
Funding secured to support the research project Cognition-Based Auto-Adaptive Website User Interface in Real Time.

Experiential Learning and Teaching Innovation

Anchor: Interactive Quizzing Framework **Present**
Developed a generative-AI quizzing framework that turns course materials into personalized formative assessments that strengthen learning outcomes.

Application of AI in Business Course Website **Present**
Designed and use an interactive course website as a live teaching environment for BUSI 654, integrating lecture content with embedded quizzes and interactive visualizations to support active learning and in-class discussion.

AILSS: AI-Powered Learning Support System **2025 – Present**
Developing an automated formative assessment tool using Large Language Models (LLMs) to provide personalized academic support to students with disabilities. (Funded by UCW Explore Grant).

Spreed.dev
Built an interactive web application that enables students to execute behavioral LLM experiments (e.g., to identify biases) in Digital Business and AI courses.

Behavioral-LLM
Created a research and classroom tool for rating and choice experiments that tests Large Language Models as consumer decision-making agents.

Gradient Descent Visual Demo
Developed an interactive web application used in graduate teaching to make machine learning optimization concepts observable in real time.

Curriculum and Program Development

Program Developer, University Canada West **2025**
Master of Financial Innovation and Technology (MoFiT)

- Member, AI specialization development team developing a graduate program at the intersection of finance and digital technology
- Course developer: *Machine Learning Applications for Finance*

Program Developer, University Canada West **2025**
Master of Health Management and Innovation

- Member, review board aligning with BC Degree Quality Assessment Board (DQAB)

Program Developer, University Canada West **2025**
Bachelor of Applied Information Technology

- **Lead course developer**: *Responsible AI* – curriculum on the ethical and societal impact of AI on business and work

- Course developer: *Fundamentals of Artificial Intelligence*

Invited Talks and Media

Expert Commentary, Business Insider **2026**

- Quoted on monetization incentives and principal–agent conflicts in AI shopping agents in *"Instinct Users Say Its AI Agent Is Pushing Unsolicited Products."*

Invited Speaker, Virginia State Bar **2026**

- Delivered a session titled "*AI and the Law: Interpreting How AI Works for You.*" for the Continuing Legal Education (CLE) program.

Guest, BIG Strategy Podcast **2025**

- Featured guest on *E029: How AI is Changing Marketing with Dr. Davood Wadi*.

Academic Service

Reviewer for Academic Journals and Conferences **2022 – Present**

- *Journal of Electronic Commerce Research* (2026)
- *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)* (2025)
- *International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Statistics (AISTATS)* (2025)
- *Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)* (2022, 2024)

Research Ethics Board Member, University Canada West **2026**
Overseeing research compliance and ethical standards for academic projects.

Reviewer, University Canada West **2025**
MBAR 661 - Academic Research Project

- Research proposal and final project evaluation

Committee Member, Great Learning **2021 – 2025**

- Served on evaluation committees for final project presentations in *MIT Applied Data Science* Program